



GLOBAL ORGANIC TEXTILE STANDARD
ECOLOGY & SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

GOTS VERSION 8.0

Major changes from v7.0 to 8.0

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HOUSEKEEPING



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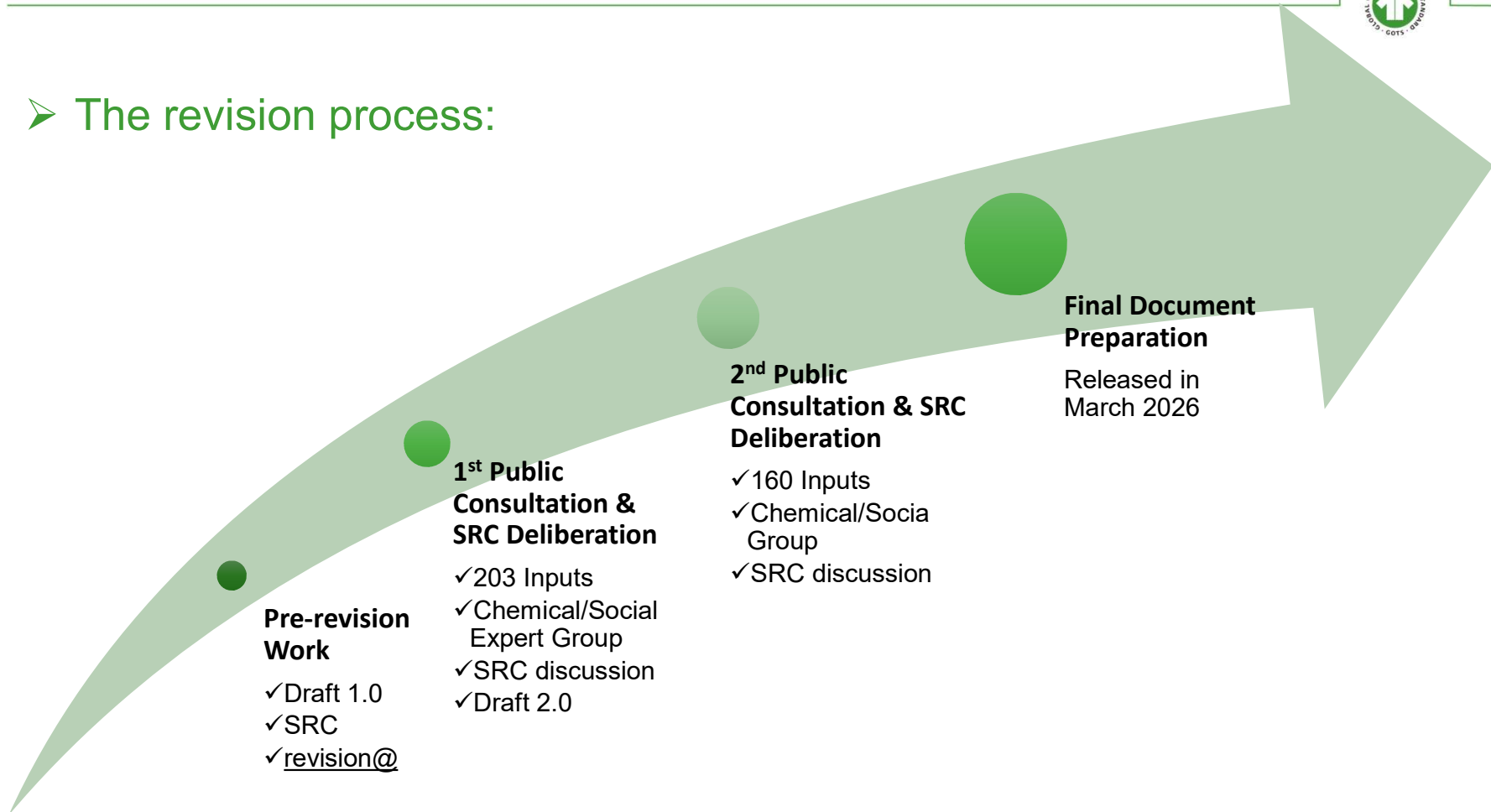
AGENDA



- General Updates
- Major Changes in GOTS 8.0 & the Implementation Manual 8.0
- Q&A Session



➤ The revision process:





SECTION 3

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3.1 Organic Fibre & GMO Testing

- **NEW test method:** ISO 5354 -1 and ISO 5354-2 shall be applied for **qualitative GMO screening of cotton**.
- **Transitional timeline:** Until March 2027, the entry into force of GOTS v8.0 → ISO/IWA 32, and ISO 5354-1/2; **afterwards only** ISO 5354-1/2.
- **Guidance:**
 - Only on unprocessed (raw/greige) cotton, as established by ISO 5354-1/2.
 - Chemically processed cotton/textile samples do not provide valid test results.



3.2 Additional Fibre Materials

- Blending rules are further clarified with examples (3.2.7)
 - Mixing the same type of fibres
- 3.2.7 The following guidelines shall be observed when blending fibres of the same type within a single product:
- a. Organic and organic in-conversion fibres of the same type cannot be blended into one product, e.g., organic cotton and organic in-conversion cotton.
 - b. Organic fibres or organic in-conversion fibres cannot be blended with conventional fibres of the same type into one product, e.g., organic wool and conventionally produced wool.
 - c. Organic fibres and recycled organic fibres of the same type cannot be blended into one product, e.g., organic wool and recycled organic wool.
 - d. Organic in-conversion fibres and recycled organic in-conversion fibres of the same type cannot be blended into one product, e.g., organic in-conversion cotton and recycled organic in-conversion cotton.
 - e. Virgin and recycled fibres of the same type cannot be mixed in the same product, e.g., virgin polyamide and recycled polyamide.
- 3.2.8 Conventionally grown cotton (virgin, recycled, or non-GMO) shall not be blended into any GOTS Good, e.g., organic wool and recycled conventional cotton.



3.2 Additional Fibre Materials

➤ **NEW Exception** under Row **7. Recycled synthetic (polymer) fibres:**

- **! EXCEPTION** Socks: up to 30% ($\leq 30\%$)
- **! EXCEPTION** Textile-to-textile recycled: up to 30% ($\leq 30\%$)

7 Recycled synthetic (polymer) fibres derived from pre- or post-consumer waste: only polyester, polyamide, polypropylene, elastomultiester (elasterell-p), polyurethane, elastane (spandex), elastolefin

✓ **ALLOWED** up to 20% ($\leq 20\%$)
(individually or combined)
! EXCEPTION Socks: up to 30% ($\leq 30\%$) (individually or combined)
! EXCEPTION Textile-to-textile recycled: up to 30% ($\leq 30\%$) (individually or combined)



3.3 Accessories

- **NEW prohibition:** *“Decorative glitter composed of insoluble and non-biodegradeable plastics”* → **PROHIBITED**
- **NEW guidance** outlines the use of alternative glitters

- a. Prohibited Glitter: insoluble and non-biodegradable glitters shall not be used.
- b. Permissible Glitter: soluble*, biodegradable**, natural, or inorganic glitters may be used only.
- c. Testing for solubility and biodegradability:
 - * Determination of polymer solubility test – Regulation (EC) No 1907/2006 Annex XVII Appendix 16, OECD Guideline 120
 - ** Biodegradability testing – Regulation (EC) No 1907/2006 Annex XVII Appendix 15, OECD Guideline 301B



3.3 Accessories

- More on the fibre composition rules:

B. Linings for apparel

- | | |
|--|-----------|
| 1. Textile fibre blends shall contain a minimum of 70% certified organic or organic in-conversion fibres. Any additional fibres used shall be limited to those permitted under Section 3.2.10, Allowed and Prohibited Additional Fibres. | ✓ ALLOWED |
|--|-----------|

C. Fillings, stuffings

- | | |
|---|-----------|
| 1. For textile fibre use: | |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Textile fibre blends shall contain a minimum of 70% certified organic or organic in-conversion fibres. Any additional fibres used shall be limited to those permitted under Section 3.2.10, Allowed and Prohibited Additional Fibres. | ✓ ALLOWED |



SECTION 4

ENVIRONMENTAL, SOCIAL AND GOVERNANCE CRITERIA



SECTION 4.1

DUE DILIGENCE MANAGEMENT PROCESS

Implementing the recommendations of the OECD

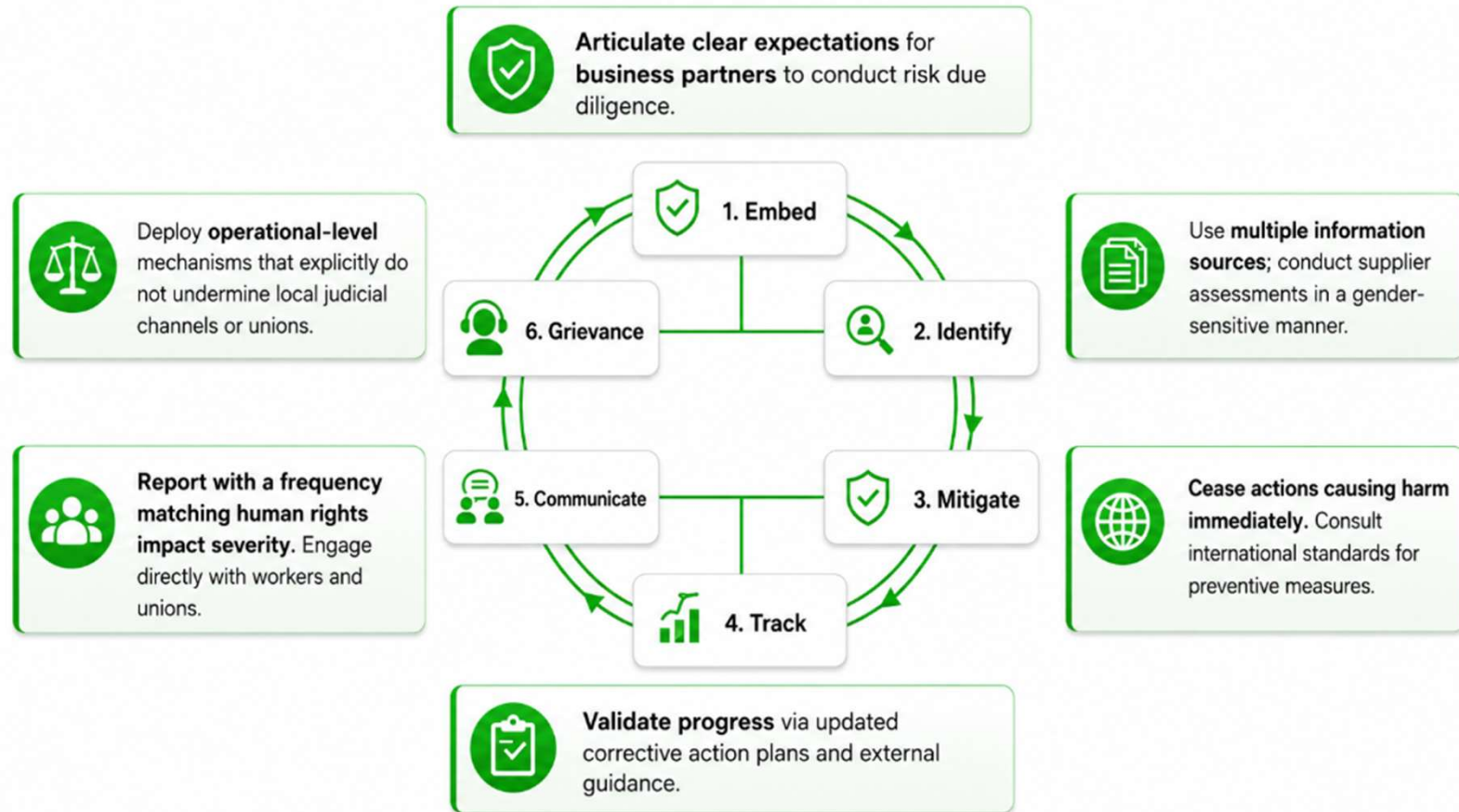


- **Due diligence is a comprehensive, documented process that requires policies, information systems, risk assessments, and independent audits.**
- **Systemic integration of OECD due diligence frameworks across the supply chain, mandating gender-sensitive assessments and multiple information sources.**



- **Proactive Due Diligence** (Anticipating risks, zero-tolerance policies, establishing functional information management systems).
- **Better alignment with OECD Due Diligence Guidance** and specific **ILO Conventions**.
- **Bridging structural gaps** (e.g., Living Wage), continuous **internal auditing**, and **deploying active remediation plans**.

GOTS 8.0 SECTION 4.1: SIX STEP DUE DILIGENCE FRAMEWORK





➤ Control

Implement **internal purchasing practice controls** to prevent contributing to harm, even if specific instances haven't yet been identified.

➤ Mitigate

As long as an ongoing relationship exists, **demonstrate continuous, documented efforts to mitigate identified adverse impacts.**

➤ Disengage (The Last Resort)

If mitigation fails, **execute disengagement with three strict prerequisites:**

✓ **Justify**

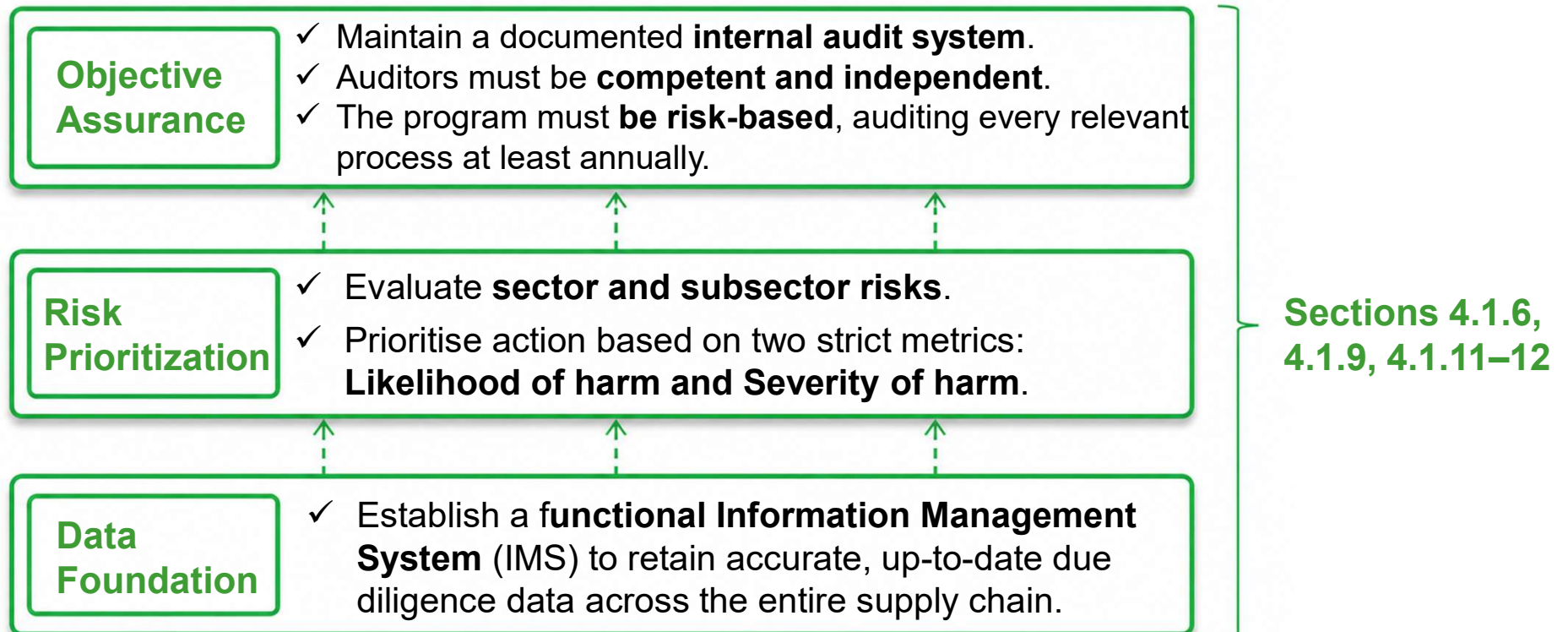
Provide business decision data to supplier management and existing unions.

✓ **Notify**

Provide sufficient notice before terminating the relationship.

✓ **Comply**

Ensure the exit adheres to national laws, international labour standards, and collective bargaining terms.





- Documented internal audit system
- Risk-based audit planning and implementation
- Corrective actions, records, and competence expectations
- Smaller Certified Entities – simplified internal audit model
– Section 4.1.11, GOTS 8.0 and Implementation Manual



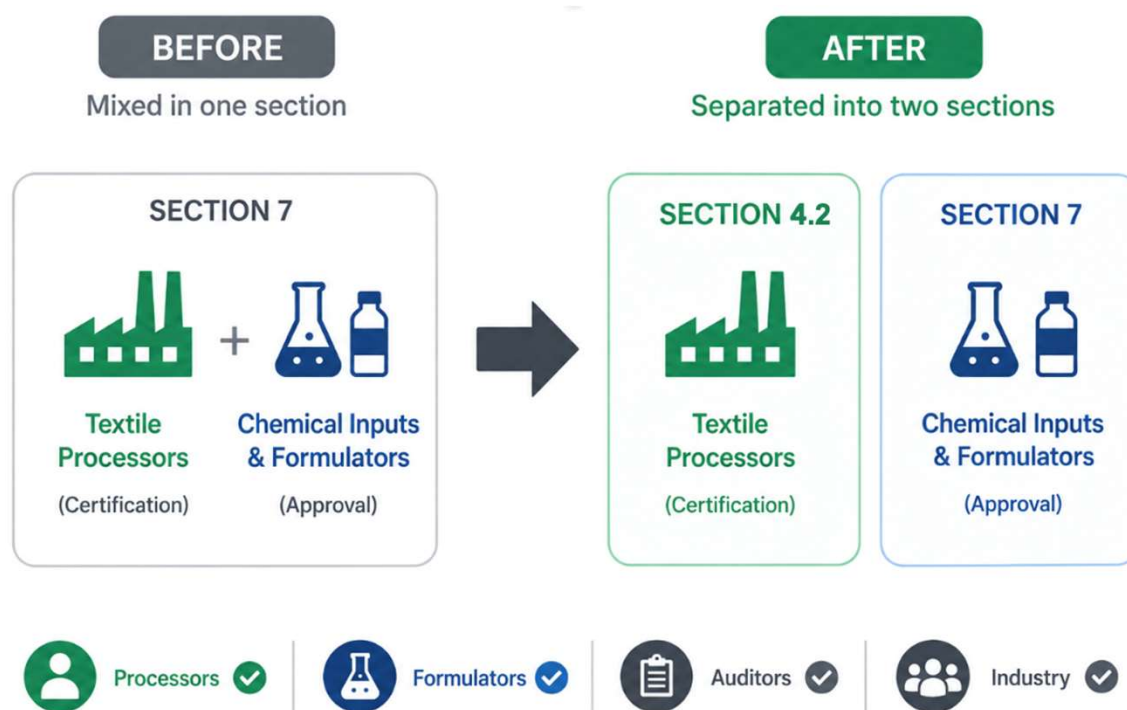
SECTION 4.2

TEXTILE PROCESSING CRITERIA



➤ Content Structure Update:

- Chemical input criteria moved to *Section 7: Chemical Input Approval Criteria*
- Clarifies **GOTS MRSL requirements** and **approval scheme**
- Distinguishes:
 - ✓ Textile processors vs. chemical formulators
 - ✓ GOTS certification vs. GOTS approval





➤ 4.2.2.2, d - Spinning

- **New specific exemption** has been granted for the controlled use of polyvinyl alcohol (PVA).
- Technical conditions are set out as:
 - i. *Certified Entities may use PVA fibres intended for dissolution during the spinning process, only when a PVA recycling/recovery system is in place, achieving **a minimum recovery rate of 50%** by weight of the aqueous solution.*
 - ii. *Only GOTS-approved PVA chemicals shall be used.*
 - iii. *Recovered PVA may be reused within the process without limitation on the quantity.*



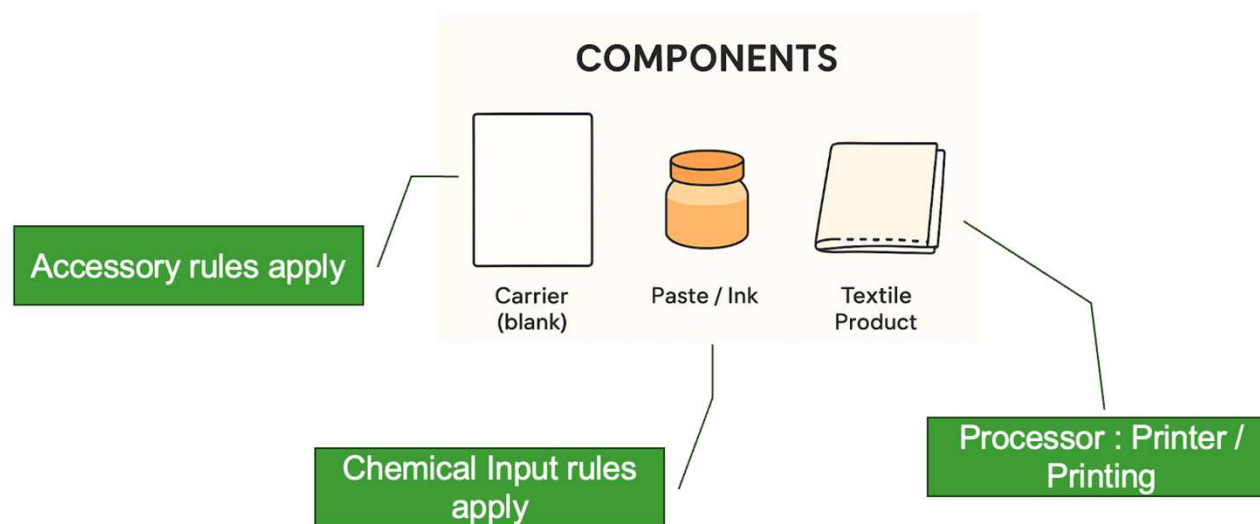
➤ 4.2.2.4, a - Non-woven Manufacture

▪ New specific exemption:

*“Biocidal active Substance(s) that comply with European biocidal products regulation (BPR 528/2012) and are listed on the Union list of BPR for product type PT11 (preservatives for process system), which are exceptionally allowed may be used for **hydroentanglement process.**”*

➤ 4.2.2.7, Printing

- **NEW guidance for transfer prints**, clarifying applicable requirements for involved actors:





➤ 4.2.2.8, Table - Finishing and Manufacturing

- The use of PFAS-based chemistry has historically been prohibited
- The prohibition of PFAS-specific repellency has been underlined and reworded for clarity:

4. Use of synthetic Inputs for anti-microbial finishing (including biocides); PFAS for oil, water, stain repellency; coating; filling and stiffening; lustering; matting, and weighting.

✗ PROHIBITED

- PFAS-free repellency & GOTS positive list: helping industry to phase out



SECTION 4.3: Environmental and Chemical Management Criteria

- 4.3 Environmental and Chemical Management Criteria 18**
 - 4.3.9 Resource Efficiency: Water, Energy and Chemical Use 19
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 - 4.3.13 Wastewater Management..... 23
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➤ **4.3.9 – Resource Efficiency: Water, Energy, and Chemical Use**

- Emphasis on sustainable resource management – establish and implement documented procedures and measures including monitoring, data collection, and continuous improvement for water, energy, chemical consumption.



➤ 4.3.10 – Air Emissions

- Documented air emission management procedures required.
 - Emission sources, monitoring approaches, quantification methods and etc.
 - Example: Emission inventory (sources, parameters and quantification methods)
- If no local legal requirements exist, an internal strategy and declaration are still required.
- Pollutant scope expanded: PM, NO_x, SO_x, VOC/TOC, HAP/TAP, heavy metals, GHGs and emerging pollutants.



➤ 4.3.11 – Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Emission Management

- New standalone GHG management requirement under the Environmental and Chemical Management Policy.
- Align with GHG Protocol or ISO 14064; define boundaries and Scope 1, 2 and 3 categories.
 - Establish data collection, emission factor sources and monitoring mechanisms.
 - Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions shall be calculated at least annually.
 - Scope 3: identify and prioritise relevant categories and improve data quality over time.
- A dedicated **GHG Emission Guideline** is currently under development to support implementation, with release planned for Q3.



➤ 4.3.13 Wastewater Management

- **NEW:** Effluent Treatment Plant (ETP) set up types and concerned rules:
 - a. *Direct discharge*
 - b. *Indirect discharge with pretreatment (with sludge)*
 - c. *Indirect discharge with pretreatment (without sludge)*
 - d. *Indirect discharge without pretreatment*
 - e. *Zero Liquid Discharge (ZLD)*
- Certified Entities **with a direct wastewater** discharge system ➔ GOTS wastewater requirements.
- Certified Entities **without a direct wastewater** discharge system ➔ may follow *ZDHC Wastewater and Sludge Guidelines* for compliance to this section.



➤ 4.3.13 Wastewater Management

▪ **NEW: Microfibre Management at Processor**

- Incorporate microfibre risks in the environmental management policy
- Identify hotspots, if any
- Develop plans to better manage them



➤ 4.3.14 Textile Waste Management

- **NEW section** focuses on textile waste management at Certified Facilities
- Ensuring that textile waste is properly managed, reduced, and reintegrated into the value chain as part of circularity strategies at processors
- **Requirements for CEs:**
 - Manage textile waste in accordance with the Waste Hierarchy, giving priority to prevention and reduction, followed by reuse, recycling, recovery, and, as a last resort, disposal.
 - Establish mechanisms for the collection, segregation, and sorting
 - Have plans to segregate organic certified textile fibre waste



➤ 4.3.15 Packaging Criteria

- **NEW** stand-alone section to better address the emerging concerns and regulatory topics.
- **NEW** categorisation: “*primary packaging*” and “*secondary packaging*”
- Certified Entities shall record information on all packaging materials used for certified products (4.3.15.1)
- Where plastic packaging is used, Certified Entities should **maximise the use of post-consumer recycled content** to the highest technically feasible percentage and target a minimum of **35% post-consumer** recycled content (4.3.15.3.4).
- Oxo-degradable, oxo-fragmentable plastics, pro-oxidant additives → accelerate fragmentation, shall not be used (4.3.15.3.7).



SECTION 4.4: HUMAN RIGHTS AND SOCIAL CRITERIA

OVERVIEW OF CHANGES TO SECTION 4.4.



- Freedom of Association
- Forced & Child Labour
- OHS & Climate Change
- Wages & Living Wage Gap
- Migrant Workers & Harassment

SECTION 4.4: HUMAN RIGHTS AND SOCIAL CRITERIA



- New references to the international instruments, conventions, and guidelines added to the Manual for the Implementation of GOTS 8.0:
 - **UN Human Rights Instruments:** Convention on the Rights of the Child, Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women
 - **ILO Conventions and Recommendations:** Protection of Workers' Health Recommendation (No. 97), Hygiene (Commerce and Offices) Convention (No.120), Employment Injury Benefits Convention (No. 121) and others.
 - Other International Frameworks & Guidelines



- A zero-tolerance policy for forced labour
–Section 4.4.2, The Implementation Manual
- A recommendation to establish workplace-based child monitoring committees
– Section 4.4.3, GOTS 8.0
- Both sections mandate that Certified Entities consider risk factors specific to the garment and footwear sector as outlined by the OECD.
- The Manual added references to the Protocol of 2014 to the Forced Labour Convention and the 2025 revised edition of the ILO Indicators of Forced Labour



➤ **Standard Legal Environments**

- Implement proactive measures to ensure compliance with GOTS criteria.
- Establish a clear policy prohibiting anti-worker practices in own operations and across the supply chain.
- Reference OECD descriptions of anti-union policies and practices.
 - New Guidance to Section 4.4.6, the Implementation Manual

➤ **Restricted Legal Environments (Section 4.4.6.10 and 4.4.6.11, GOTS 8.0)**

- Certified Entities must design appropriate alternative channels.
- Do not hinder free association or the development of independent dialogue.
- Allow workers to freely elect or nominate representatives; enter into dialogue specifically with these representatives.



- Certified Entities shall develop emergency response plans for extreme weather events like heat, floods, and storms, and to monitor environmental conditions such as temperature and humidity
 - Sections 4.4.7.15 and 4.4.7.16, GOTS 8.0
- Guidance concerning these climate mitigation plans
 - Sections 4.4.7.15 and 4.4.7.16, The Implementation Manual
- A requirement to follow the ILO Code of Practice on Safety and Health
 - Section 4.4.7.1, The Implementation Manual
- For emergency responses, the **plans must detail procedures for halting work, conducting safe worker evacuations, and providing access to immediate medical care.**



- **Standard working week wages must meet basic needs and provide discretionary income**
 - Section 4.4.8.2, GOTS 8.0
- A requirement to use **credible estimates to calculate the "Living Wage Gap"** for workers and **develop a concrete plan to bridge that gap**
 - Sections 4.4.8.9 and 4.4.8.10, GOTS 8.0
- Further guidance on remuneration criteria and credible living wage estimates
 - Sections 4.4.8.2, 4.4.8.9, and 4.4.8.10, The Implementation Manual



- Protection to migrant workers by ensuring they are **not deprived of their travel documents** and requiring that the Certified Entities **bear all recruitment, travel, and pre-departure training fees**
 - Section 4.4.11.2, GOTS 8
- Inclusion of the reference to the Dhaka Principles for Migration with Dignity
 - Section 4.4.11, The Implementation Manual
- The Manual highlights Principles 1 and 2 of the Dhaka Principles, which focus on:
 - **equal treatment** and
 - **ethical recruitment throughout the migration cycle.**



SECTION 5: Product Compliance Criteria



➤ 5.2.6 – Technical Quality Parameters

- Product testing categories: “Fastness”, “Durability/Robustness”, and “Other”
- **NEW Durability/Robustness tests:** “Spirality” and “Visual Inspection After Wash”, compliance limits and testing methods.
- **NEW testing specifications:** 5 wash cycles are required for Durability/Robustness tests, unless otherwise stated. For temperature settings care labels to be followed.
- Dimensional Stability test methods have been clarified as ISO 5077 and ISO 3759.

PARAMETER	CRITERIA	TEST METHOD
FASTNESS TEST REQUIREMENTS:		
A. Rubbing fastness,		ISO 105 X12
Dry	3-4 3, for fibre blends	
Wet	2	
B. Perspiration fastness, alkaline and acidic		ISO 105 E04
Shade Change	3-4 3, for fibre blends	
Staining on Multifibre	3-4 3, for fibre blends	
C. Light fastness	3-4	ISO 105 B02
D. Saliva fastness <i>(only for textiles for babies)</i>	5	BVL B 82.92.3 DIN 53160-1
E. Washing fastness washed at 40°C		ISO 105 C06 A1M
Animal fibre material and blends, washed at 30°C		ISO 105 C06 A1S without steel balls
Shade Change	3-4	
Staining on Multifibre	3-4	
DURABILITY / ROBUSTNESS TEST REQUIREMENTS:		
<i>! Applicable only to the final goods.</i>		
F. Dimensional stability		ISO 3759, ISO 6330, ISO 5077
Knitted/hosiery	± 5%	
Woven	± 3%	
G. Spirality		ISO 16322-3, ISO 6330
Knitted/hosiery	± 5%	
Woven	± 5%	
H. Visual Inspection After Washing <i>Colour, fabric, seams, non-textile parts</i>	3 Moderate change in appearance	ISO 15487, ISO 6330
OTHER:		
I. Microfibre Shedding / Fibre Fragmentation <i>See the Manual for the Implementation of GOTS v8.0 for further guidance.</i>		ISO 4484-1/2/3, AATCC TM 212, TMC Test Method

Table 7: Technical Quality Requirements for GOTS Goods



➤ 5.2.6 – Technical Quality Parameters

- **NEW parameter and monitoring activity:** “Microfibre Shedding / Fibre fragmentation” parameter has been included.
- **NEW guidance for the implementation:** Monitoring activity aims to generate baseline data of GOTS Goods:
 - All actors within the GOTS supply chain are encouraged to contribute
 - Acceptable test methods:
 - a. *ISO 4484-1-3*
 - b. *AATCC TM 212*
 - c. *The Microfibre Consortium (TMC) Test Method*
 - d. *Additional test may be considered upon submission*



➤ **5.2.7 & 5.2.8 – Limit Values for Residues (RSL)**

- **NEW parameter:** “Bisphenol A” ≤ 10 mg/kg ; “Bisphenol B, AF, F, S” ≤ 1000 mg/kg each
- **NEW parameter:** “Flame Retardants”; sum ≤ 50 mg/kg; each ≤ 10 mg/kg → EN ISO 17881-1/2
- **NEW PFAS limits & test method:**
 - Each < 25 ppb ($\mu\text{g/kg}$) ; Sum < 250 ppb ($\mu\text{g/kg}$)
 - Test method → EN ISO 17681-1:**2025** shall be used



➤ **5.2.7 & 5.2.8 – Limit Values for Residues (RSL)**

- **NEW limit for Phthalates:** for each < 50 mg/kg
- **NEW limit for Cyclic Siloxanes (D4):** 1000 ppm for each
- **NEW parameter:** “Linear siloxane, L3, 1000 ppm”
- **NEW parameter:** “Xylene” <1mg/kg has been included
- **NEW parameter:** “Styrene” <10mg/kg has been included



➤ 5.2.7 & 5.2.8 – Limit Values for Residues (RSL)

- **NEW definition:** Footnotes 12 & 14 clarify “**shorn wool**”:

*“Refers to virgin wool sheared from living animals, which is new or in other words non-recycled, ready for the spinning process, and has typically **undergone scouring or washing process.**”*



New section: 5.3 Circularity of Final GOTS Goods

Introduces requirements for circularity activities – these are post-sale processes and interventions applied to final products.



- **Why a new section on circularity of final GOTS goods?**
 - A natural response to evolving business models
 - Aligned with the regulatory landscape
 - Certification and claims now possible for circular interventions

 **Repair**
extend life

 **Resell**
second life

 **Repurpose**
new use

All under GOTS certification
label integrity preserved



- **New section: 5.3 Circularity of Final GOTS Goods**
- **NEW circular processes:** Repair, resell, and repurposing introduced
- **Applicability:**
 - Brands, retailer etc. - coordinating circularity activities
 - Not an automatic extension of mandatory certification
 - It depends on:
 - ✓ If the brand has a plan to repair, resell, repurpose GOTS Goods, and;
 - ✓ If the brand aims to maintain the certified status (e.g. resell it as GOTS)



➤ What is the gain ?

- **Safe & compliant circularity processes:** All repair, resell and repurposing activities meet GOTS safety and material standards
- **Product integrity maintained:** Certification confirms quality and safety are upheld throughout the product's lifecycle
- **Third-party verification:** External oversight continues beyond the original point of sale
- **Continued GOTS claims:** Brands can market repaired or upcycled products as GOTS certified after intervention



➤ **What are the requirements?**

Any processes performed on a certified product must comply with the relevant GOTS requirements applicable to the activity performed:

- ✓ **Mandatory certification**

- Required to retain claims following circularity processes

- ✓ **Replacement of accessories (if any)**

- The replacement components (e.g. zippers, buttons, pocket liners) must comply with the applicable GOTS accessory requirements.



➤ **Requirements (continue):**

✓ **Chemical usage (if any)**

→ Chemicals used during repair (re-dyeing, re-finishing) must comply with GOTS chemical input requirements.

✓ **Operational & informational documentation:**

→ Circular business models (e.g. repair)

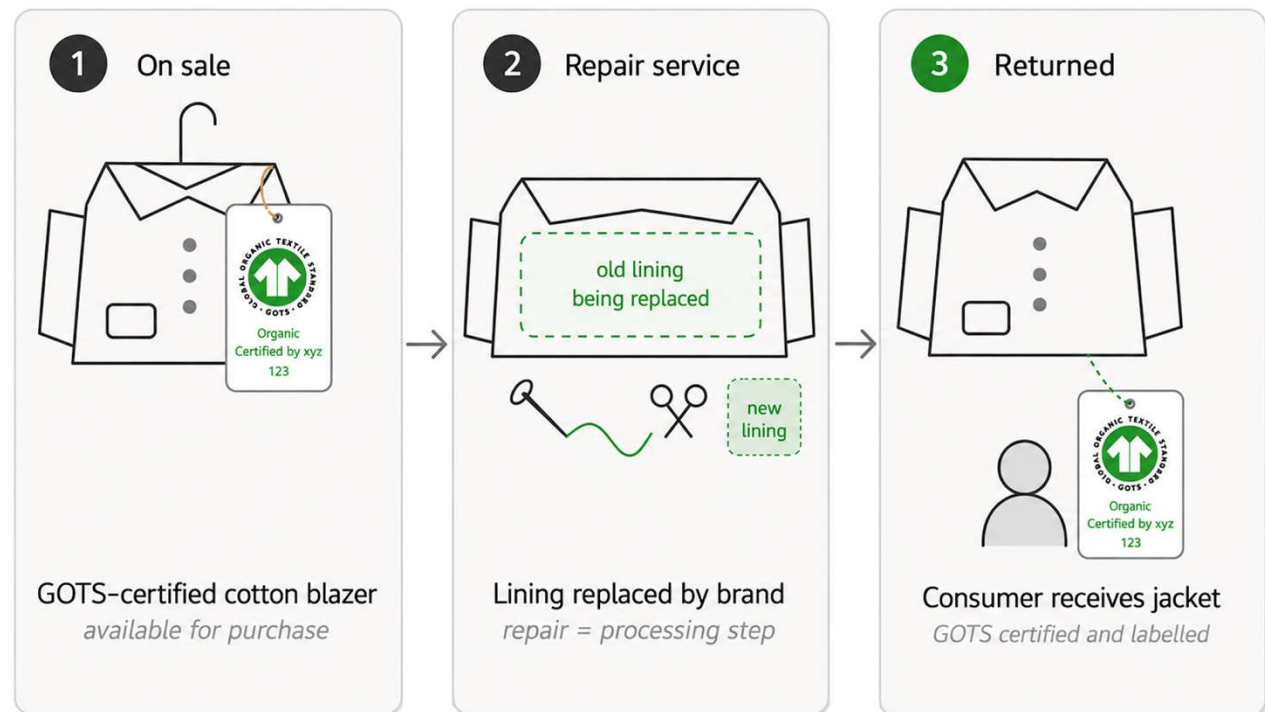
→ Ecodesign aspect (e.g. repairability)

→ Accessory, material, chemicals used for interventions (e.g. replacing zipper, lining, collar)



➤ New section: 5.3 Circularity of Final GOTS Goods

CASE: Brand X offering repair services and commits to maintain product's certified status.





CASE: What are the requirements Brand X shall follow?

- ✓ **Certification**
- ✓ **Evidence of compliance:**
 - ✓ Use GOTS compliant accessories
 - ✓ Maintain documentation for compliance

Example:

- ✓ If the zipper has been replaced during repair, the company should maintain compliance documentation such as an OEKO-TEX certificate



SECTION 6:

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS FOR SPECIAL PRODUCTS 44

6.1 Personal Care Products..... 44

6.1.4 Criteria for Personal Care Products 45

6.2 Food Contact Textiles 46

6.2.4 Criteria for Food Contact Textiles 46



➤ 6.1.4.5 Specific Criteria for Tampons

- **NEW test:** Chemical residue testing for absorbent hygiene products → CWA 18062:2023
- **NEW residue limits:** compliance with GOTS Section 5.2.7 as well as with the limits established under the **EDANA Stewardship Programme**. Where identical parameters are covered, the most stringent limit shall apply.



SECTION 7:

CHEMICAL INPUT APPROVAL CRITERIA (MRSL)



➤ 7.2 Chemical Input Requirements (MRSL)

- Clarifications and terminology changes:
 - The term “Permanent AOX” ➔ “non-hydrolysable halogens.” Reworded from
 - The term “Microplastics” ➔ “Synthetic Microplastics Polymers (SMP)”
- **NEW limits:** D4 limit ➔ 1000 mg/kg.
- **NEW parameter:** prohibition to “Linear Siloxane, L3” ➔ 1000 mg/kg
- **NEW limit:** AROMATIC AND/OR HALOGENATED SOLVENTS: Trichloroethylene ➔ 10 mg/kg.
- **NEW substances** added FLAME RETARDANTS list. New limit ➔ 50 mg/kg each and 100 mg/kg sum



➤ 7.2 Chemical Input Requirements (MRSL)

- **NEW limit:** ALKYLPHENOLS (APS) AND ALKYLPHENOETHOXYLATES (APEOS): Nonylphenol (NP) and octylphenol (OP) → 50 mg/kg each ; octylphenol ethoxylates (OPEO) and nonylphenol ethoxylates (NPEO) → 250 mg/kg each, and 250 mg/kg as sum.
- **NEW limit and testing guidance:** AROMATIC AMINES AND ANILINE (FREE): free aniline analyses → without a reductive step. **Exceptional limit** for "free aniline in **indigo colourants**" → 2000 mg/kg and analyses → "reductive extraction and result normalisation requirements based on ISO 14362."
- **NEW reference:** PER- AND POLYFLUOROALKYL SUBSTANCES (PFAS) → reference list of PFAS chemicals → AFIRM Appendix B, Version 11, 2026



➤ 7.2 Chemical Input Requirements (MRSL)

- **NEW limit:** CHLORINATED PARAFFINS (SCCP and MCCP) ➔ 250 mg/kg each.
- **NEW guidance** for Endocrine Disruptors

GUIDANCE

Assessment of Endocrine Disruptor (ED) Chemicals:

- Chemical inputs shall be evaluated for endocrine-disrupting (ED) properties in accordance with the harmonised classifications laid down in Annex VI of the EU Regulation (EC) No 1272/2008 on Classification, Labelling and Packaging (CLP).
- The harmonised ED classifications incorporated into Annex VI shall be legally binding as of June 2026 and shall be applied to ensure consistent, legally compliant, and scientifically recognised assessments.
- These classifications shall be applied uniformly for the evaluation of all chemical inputs approved under GOTS.

REFERENCES

Regulation (EC) No 1272/2008



SECTION 8:

DEFINITIONS



➤ 8. DEFINITIONS

New terms & definitions:

- Accessories
- Carbon Footprint of a Product/CFP
- Endocrine Disrupter
- Synthetic Microplastics Polymers (SMP)
- Non-hydrolasable halogens:
- Pre-consumer Waste
- Post Consumer Waste
- Post Industrial Waste
- Primary Packaging
- Secondary Packaging
- Repair, Repurpose/Repurposing, Reuse
- Waste Hierarchy.

Q&A



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